Case Study 3

Agile Co-Dev | User Research | Heuritsic Analysis | Data Analysis

RPM UI Revamp & Design System

Scaling Resource Planning for 1,000+ Global Users

The Context

The RPM Production (Resource Planning & Management) tool is Ubisoft's primary internal platform used to manage staffing across all projects. It allows teams to plan who is working where, when people will be available, and whether new roles need to be opened.

Compass sought a UX specialist to diagnose heuristic issues affecting 1,000+ users and restore confidence in a key internal tool. I addressed inconsistent patterns, clumsy workflows, and daily friction.

My Team

Me (UX Specialist)

Through cross-functional research and systems thinking, I consolidated 40+ modals, streamlined core workflows, and built a scalable framework to make the tool supportive rather than obstructive.

Product Owner

IT Team Lead

Business Analyst

UI Designers

I also mentored Developers and 2 UI Designers on Design Thinking Principles

Executive Summary

The Problem

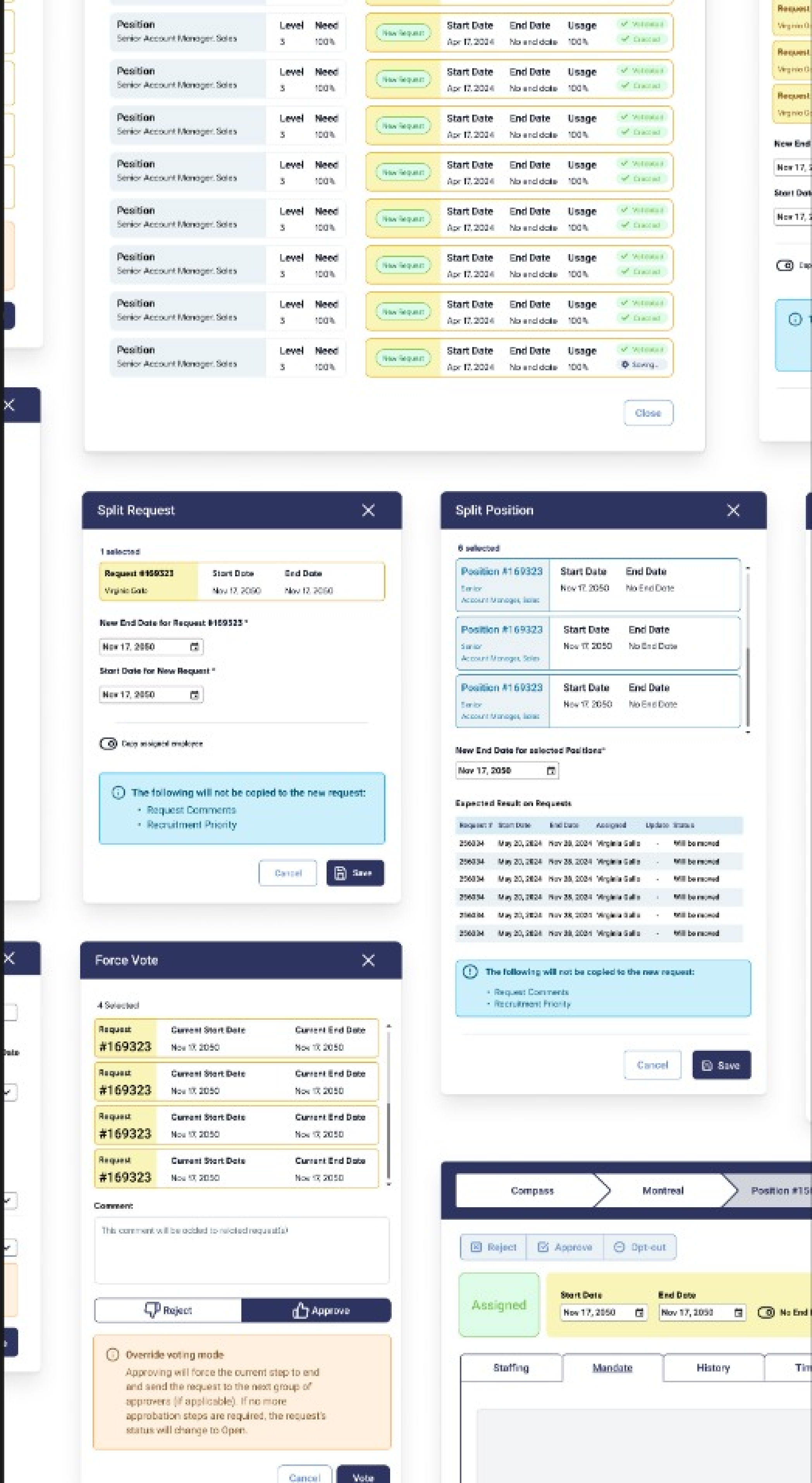
RPM is Ubisoft's primary resource planning tool, but a previous redesign left the platform with scattered workflows, confusing terminology, and a massive lack of user trust. Project Managers were overwhelmed and adoption stalled globally.

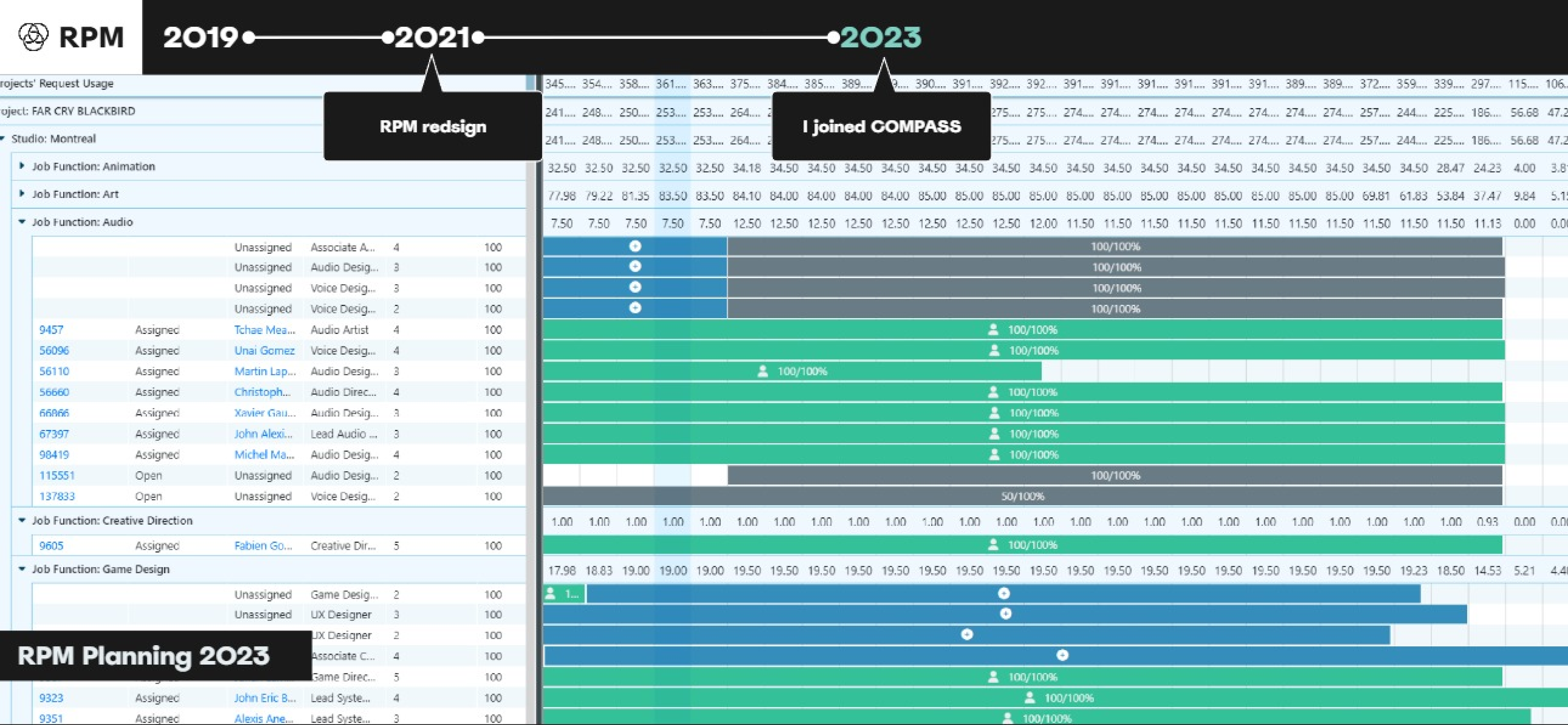
My Role & Action

As the lead UX Specialist, I initiated foundational user research to map pain points. Over 4 months, I led the strategy to consolidate 40+ modals, redesign the primary navigation ribbon, and split complex date-editing logic into digestible steps.

The Impact

By transforming the tool from an obstacle into a reliable utility, we drastically reduced user errors related to staffing timelines. The redesigned workflows established the scalable foundation required to confidently roll out RPM to global studios.





The problem

Lack of clarity and a fundamental misunderstading of users and their painpoints.

I proposed a formal research process to uncover the real user landscape and create clarity around what to fix, for whom, and why.

What was broken

- When I joined the RPM team, the tool was flooded with complaints, but no one had identified the root causes. A recent redesign had changed both the interface and the workflows, but it was done without UX input or a clear understanding of the people using it. The result? A fresh coat of paint over foundational problems.
- There was no structured research. No user segmentation. The product owner was doing reactive one-on-ones, but couldn't see the bigger picture. (who used RPM, how they used it, or what pain points mattered most.)

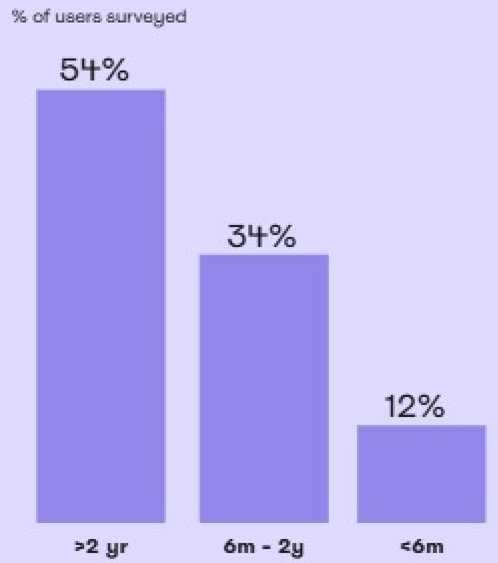
The Goal

Rebuild trust through insight, not guesswork.

Research Insights

To anchor our roadmap, we launched a global **Satisfaction Survey** and received 101 responses from users across Ubisoft. The results surfaced core disconnects between usage frequency, satisfaction, and role.

User Seniority Distribution



Satisfaction by Seniority

Job Family Distribution

Satisfaction by Job Family

Who Was Struggling

Seniority didn't help: Long-time users were the most frustrated, showing that time spent with the tool didn't ease confusion.

Frequent users rated RPM lowest for saving time. Both new and experienced users reported friction, with an average score of 2.16/5.

Project Managers were the largest group and the least satisfied 3.3/5, prompting us to run usability research and dig deeper.

Project Managers

Main Use Cases

100%	Edit existing request
100%	Open role in my project(s)
92%	Plan a ramp-up/down
67%	Realize my forecast
61%	Consult Dashboards

Restricted to Executives

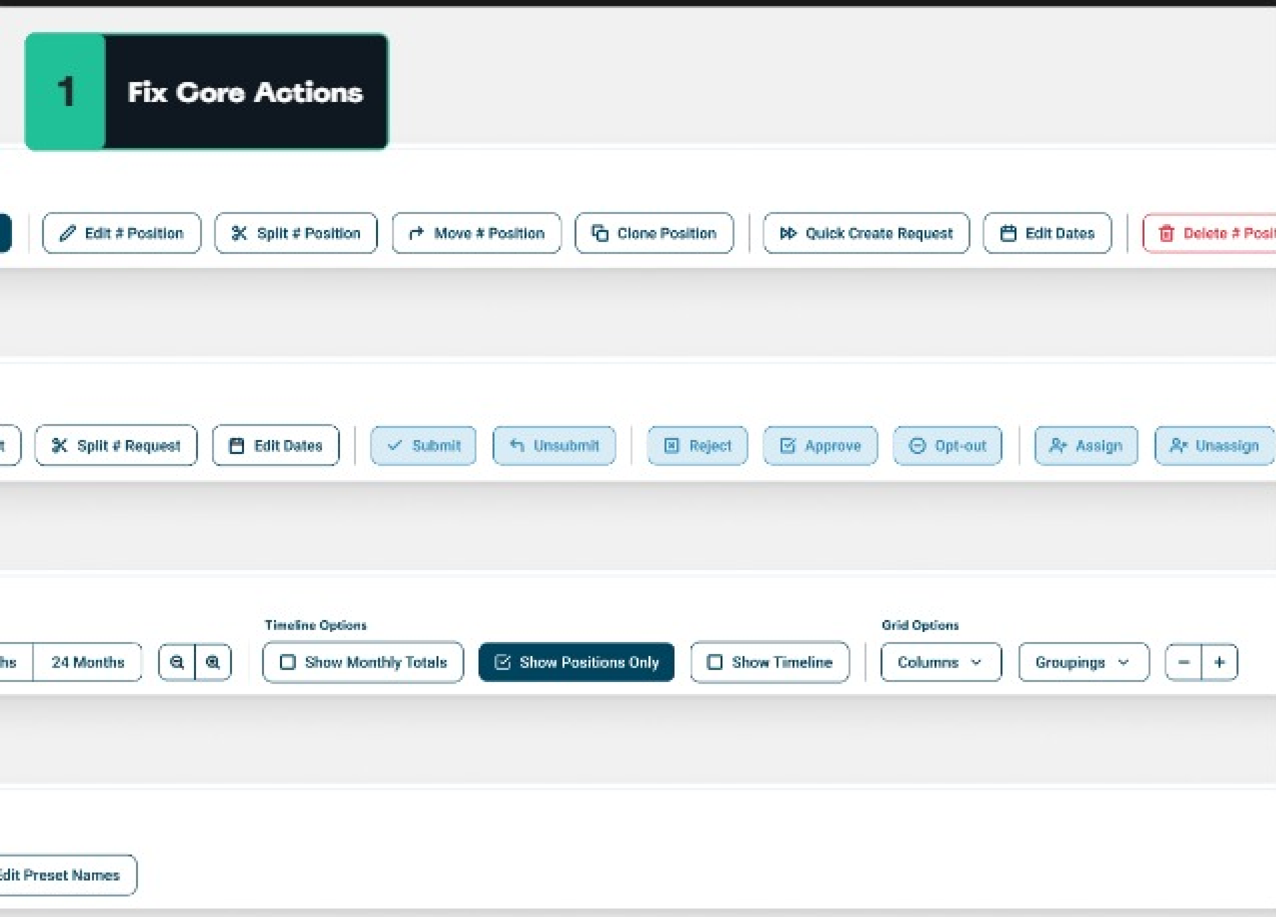
User Sentiments

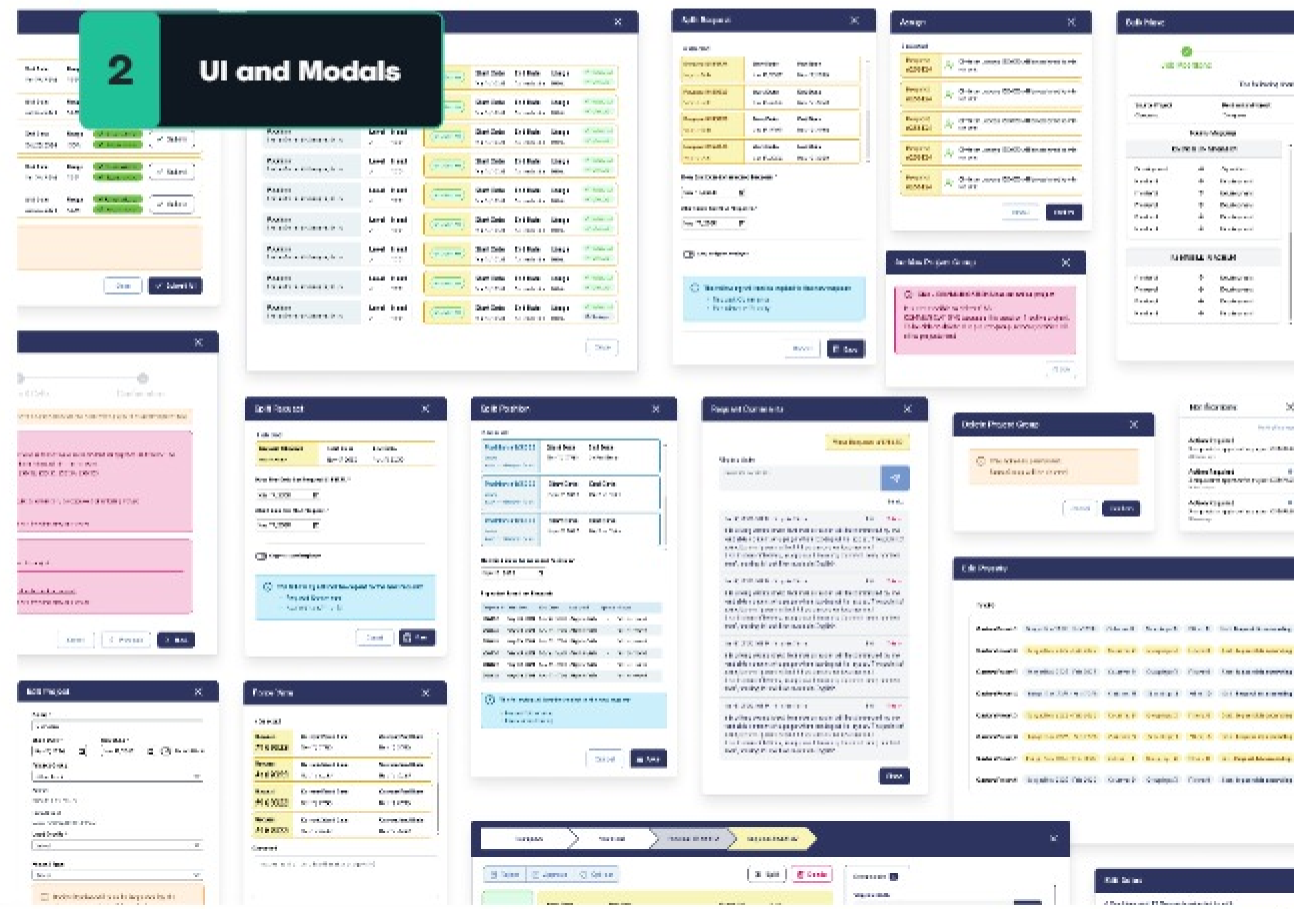
FRUSTRATED
Too many clicks for simple tasks and difficulty finding key features

OLD
The tool felt outdated and visually cluttered

OVERWHELMED
Users didn't know where to look or what to do next

A full rebuild wasn't realistic. Instead, I proposed a phased UX strategy





Timeline 2023 — April — July

Our Vision

Research revealed a deeper issue than missing features or poor UI. Users didn't trust RPM.

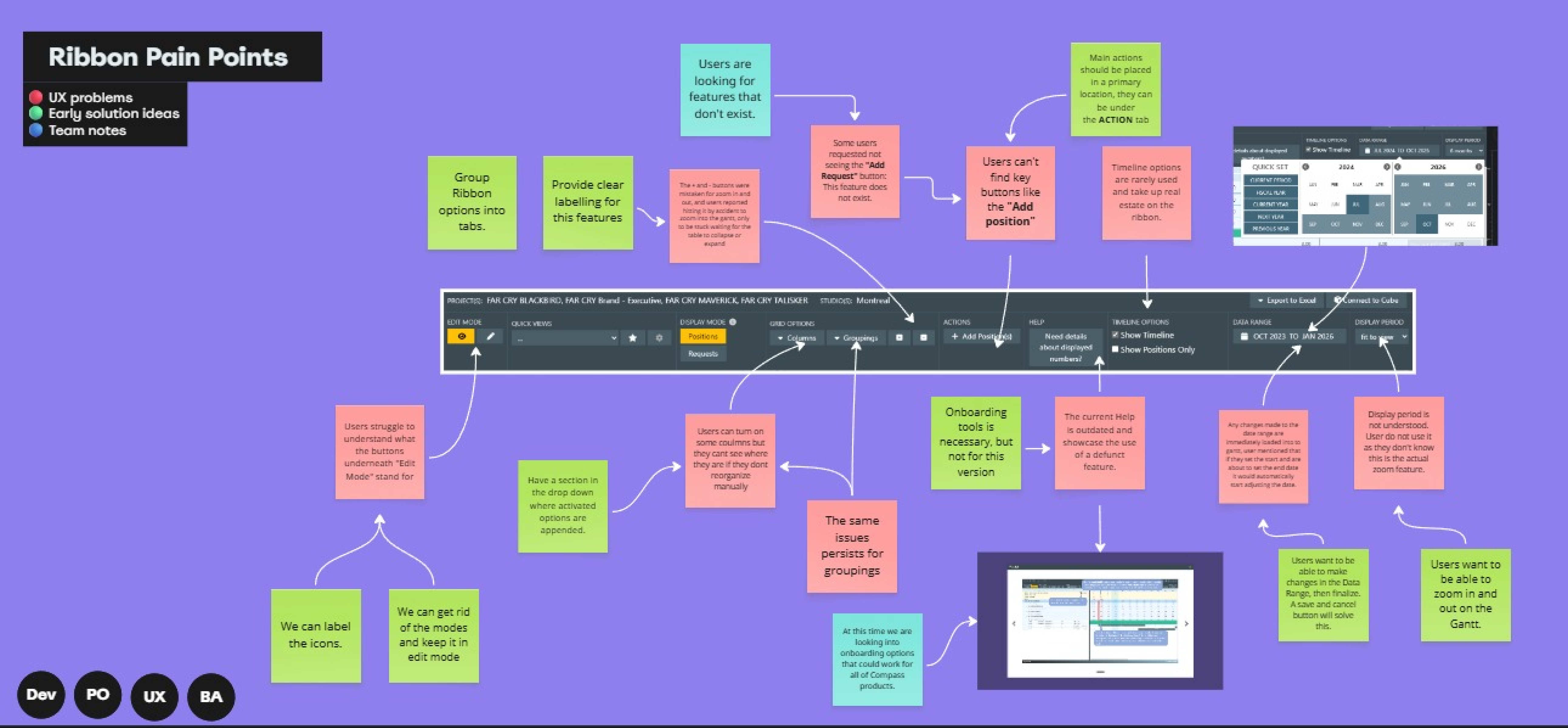
As a result, adoption remained limited to roughly a quarter of Ubisoft studios, with usage concentrated mainly in Canada and France.

Phase 1: The Ribbon

- We started where the pain was most visible, the Ribbon. This was RPM's primary navigation surface and one of the most cited friction points in both surveys and interviews. Users didn't understand the structure, misread icons, and assumed entire features were missing.

Phase 2: The Modals

- After fixing navigation and visibility, we tackled RPM's highest-risk modals—key to staffing, requests, and planning—that caused errors, rework, and support tickets.
- We audited 40+ modals, prioritized Position, Request, and Advanced Date Editor, and rebuilt them with the product team.



UX Alignment Kickoff

Before jumping into design work, I ran a cross-functional brainstorm session with the team to map the biggest UX breakdowns in RPM.

Objective 1

Identify key usability issues in the Ribbon and Modal UI using user feedback

Objective 2

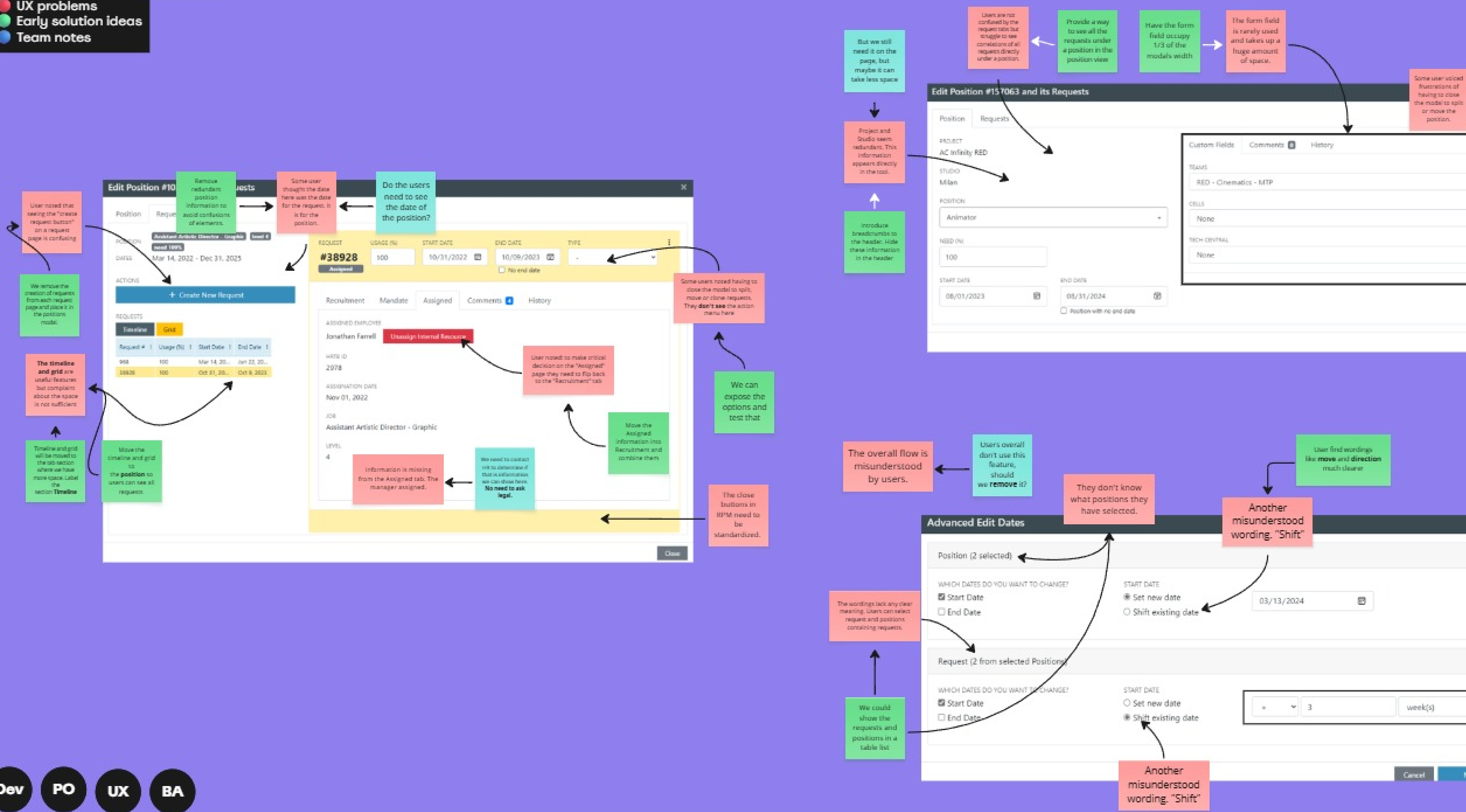
Explore multiple design solutions for each pain point

Objective 3

Prioritize based on impact vs effort for handoff to the BA and roadmap planning

3 Major Modals

- UX problems
- Early solution ideas
- Team notes

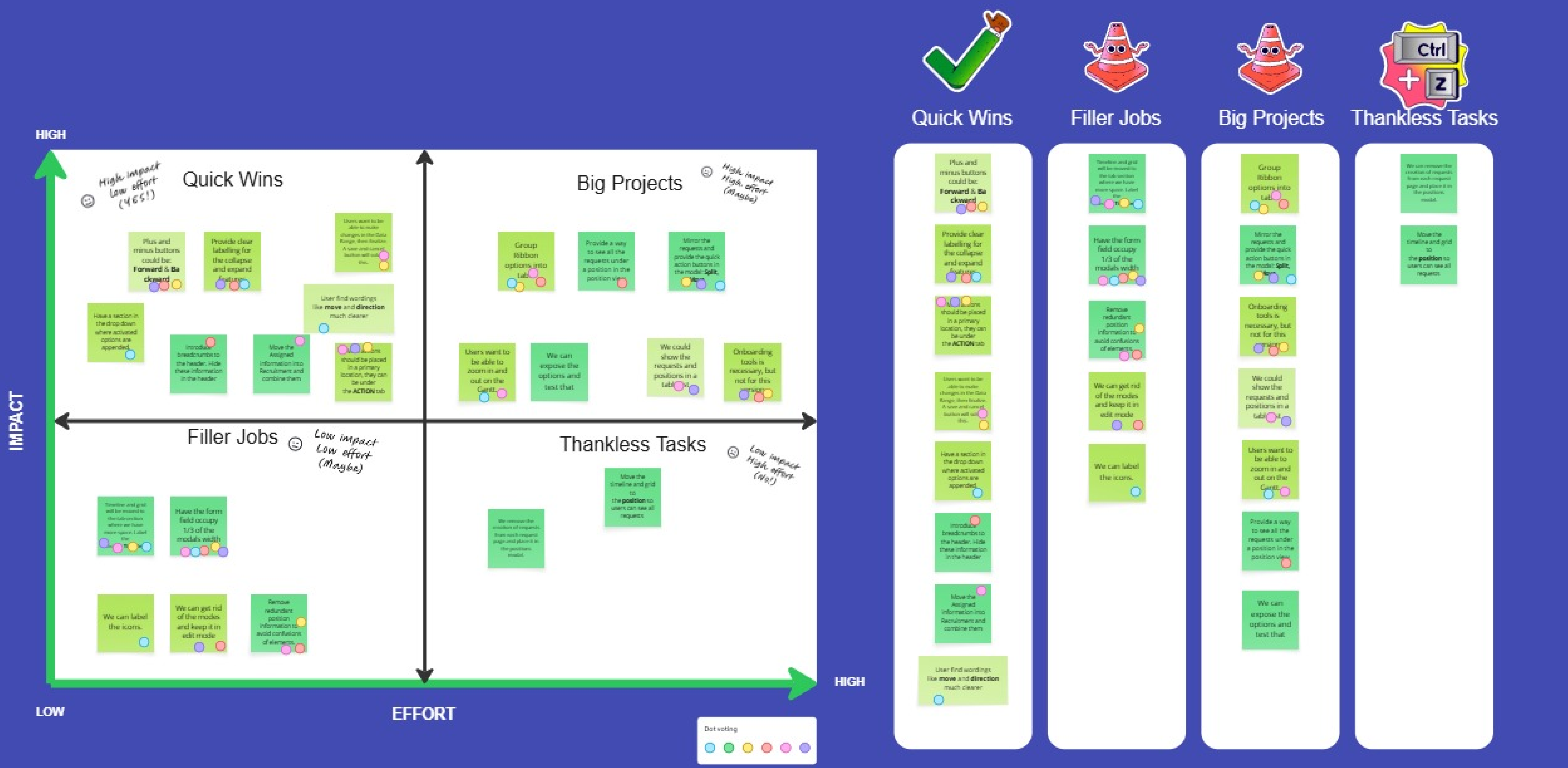


Dev PO UX BA

UX Alignment Kickoff part 2

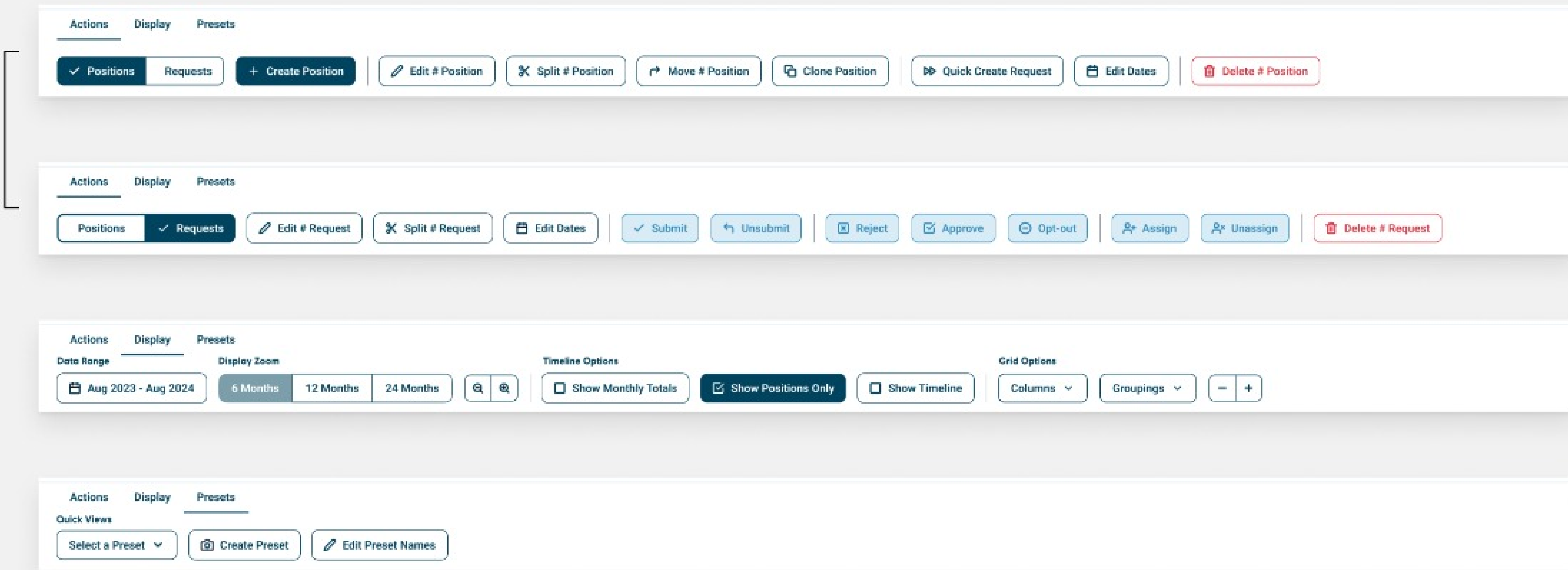
Prioritizing

After brainstorming over 20 solutions, we used dot-voting and an Impact vs Effort matrix to prioritize actions. The top items became our "quick wins" for early delivery, while more complex flows were phased into future sprints.



Ribbon Redesign

The Ribbon was RPM's primary navigation surface, so tackling it was our first step to victory. We focused on two things: clarity and scalability.



Strategy

We grouped related actions, exposed frequent tools, and restructured the layout around how teams actually worked; while leaving enough space for new features and system growth.

3 New Tabs

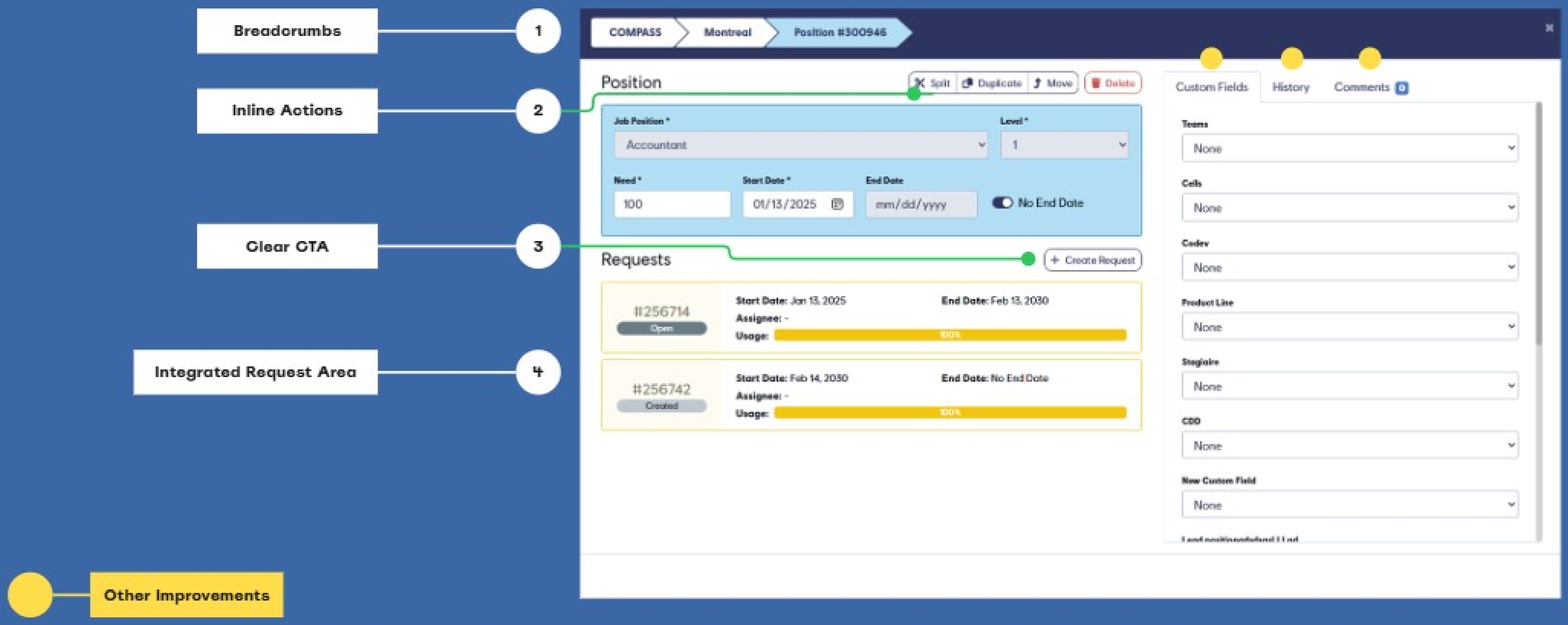
Actions Tab
High-frequency actions now left-aligned and clearly labeled

Display Tab
Gantt and Table tools relabeled and visually grouped

Presets Tab
Quick views separated for clarity and future scalability

Position Modal

Confusion here delayed staffing decisions, triggered duplicate entries, and led to frequent support requests, often for simple tasks.



What it's used for

The Position Modal is where project managers define roles, assign dates, and initiate staffing. It's one of the most-used screens in RPM and a core point of failure in the tool.

Solutions

1 - Breadcrumbs
Replaced static labels with breadcrumbs to show hierarchy and context.

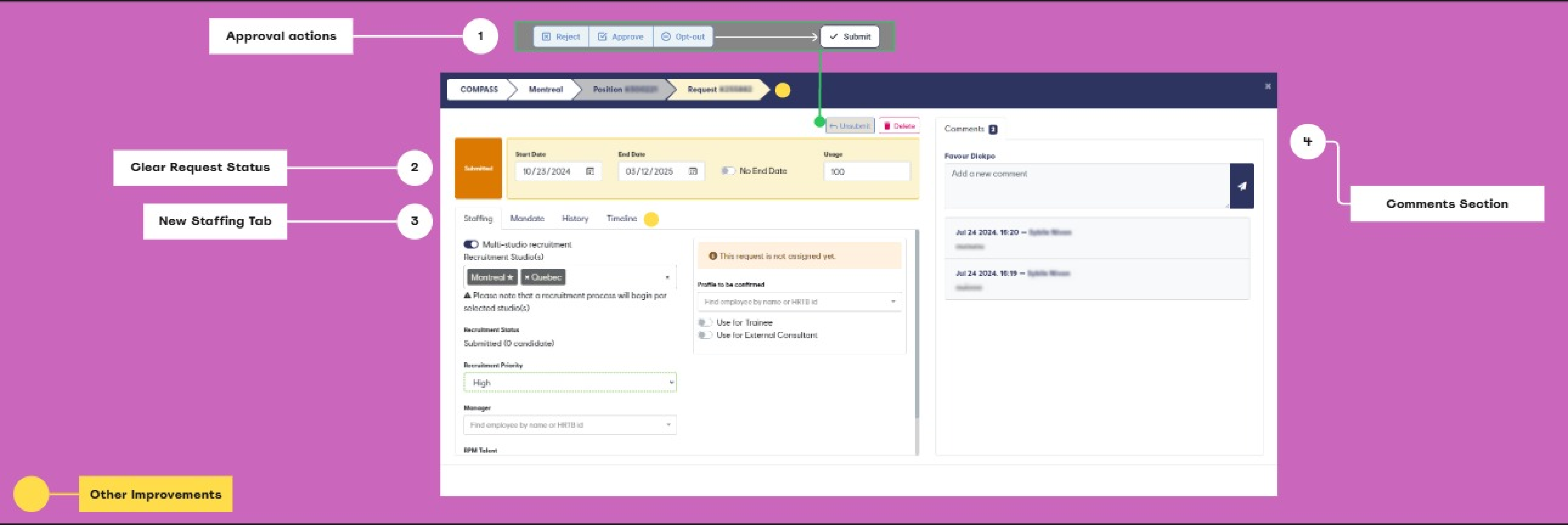
2 - Inline Actions
Added the most-used actions: Split, Clone and Move, directly inside the modal.

3 - Clear CTA
Introduced "+ Create Request" as a clear step forward for Production Managers.

4 - Integrated Request Area
Moved request entry directly into the modal, eliminating tab-switching.

Request Modal

The previous design caused confusion, decision delays, and downstream errors. It lacked visual hierarchy, scattered critical inputs, and forced users to dig for approval actions.



What it's used for

The Request Modal is where staffing gets finalized. It connects the defined role (Position) with an actual resource, making it essential to both project planning and HR operations.

Solutions

1 - Approval Actions
Moved approval actions into the request modal, where the action mattered most.

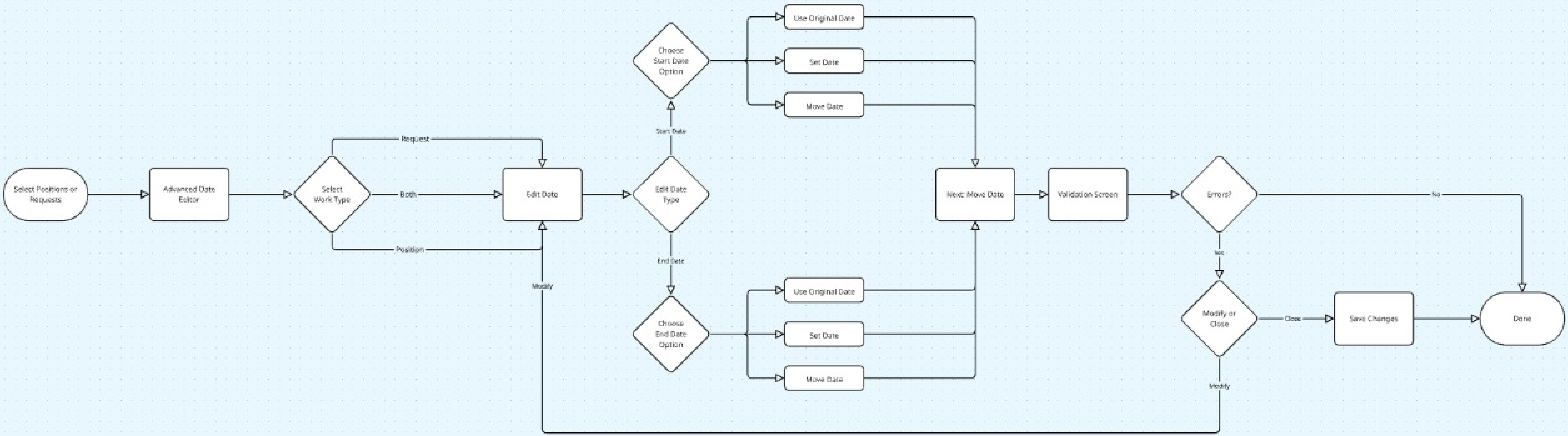
2 - Clear Request Status
Reused Gantt status colors in the modal so users instantly recognize request states.

3 - New Staffing Tab
Merged Recruitment and Assigned tabs, to reduced cognitive overload.

4 - Comments Section
Created a dedicated space for real-time collaboration and history

Advanced Date Editor

One of the most error-prone modals in the system due to the confusing user flow.



Sketching & Flows

I mapped the original flow users followed when editing dates. The sequence was rigid, ambiguous, and offered no clear separation between Start and End Date interactions. With the old flow mapped I proposed splitting the logic for Start and End Date editing. This allowed users to make precise, independent adjustments, reducing accidental changes and supporting clearer validation.

Updated Flow

1 User selects whether to edit Start Date **or** End Date

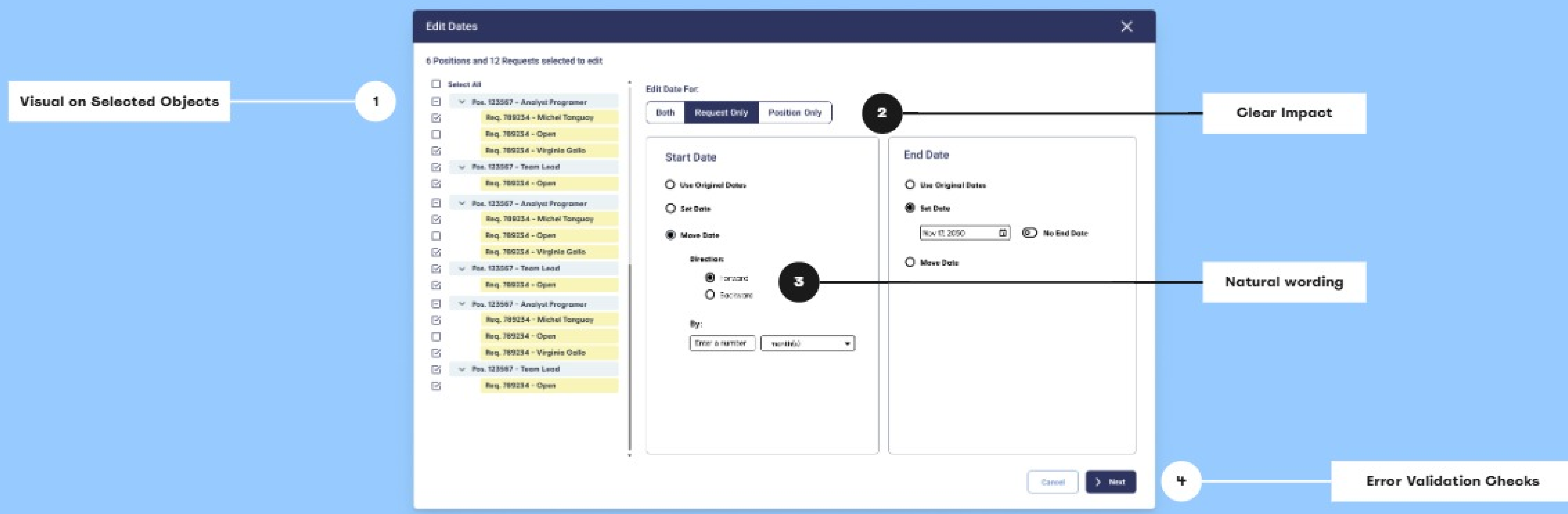
2 User chooses from three options:
- Set Date
- Move Date
- Use Original Dates

3 User inputs values

4 System runs validation and displays contextual feedback

Advanced Date Editor

One of the most error-prone modals in the system due to the confusing user flow.



Improvements

1 - Visual on Selected Objects
A section for chosen objects reduced selection and date-change errors

3 - Natural wording
Users said "move forward" and "move backwards" in interviews, so we adapted.

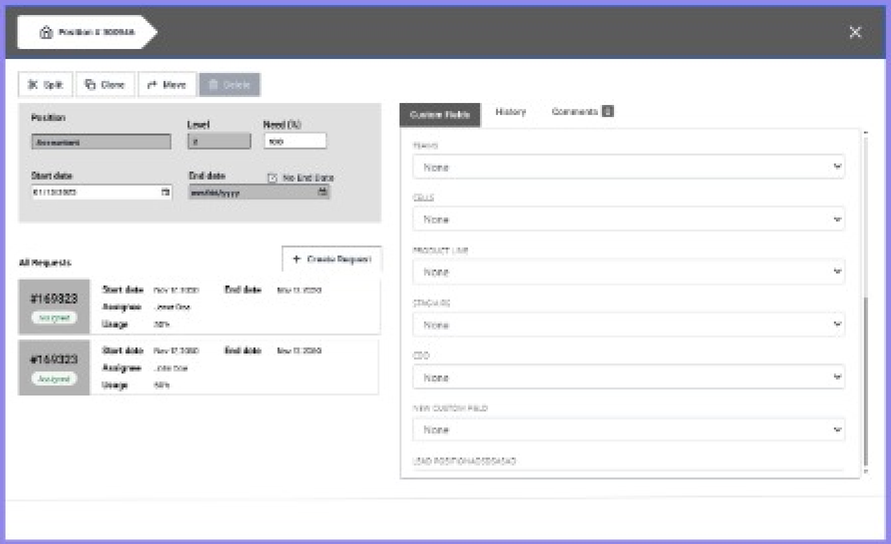
2 - Clear Impact
Users can easily identify which entities they want to adjust the dates for

4 - Error Validation Checks
Fixed previous issues where date changes failed and progress was lost.

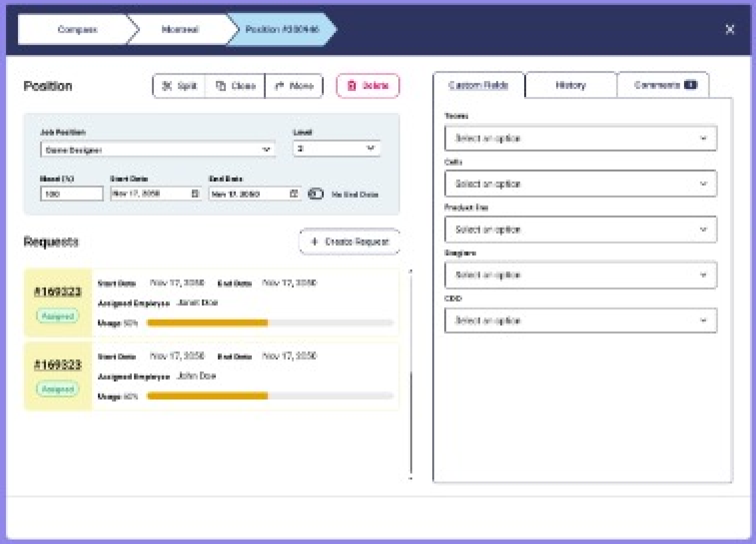
Design System Alignment

Throughout the project, we worked closely with Ubisoft's shared design team **EGG** to adapt and expand their system to fit RPM's needs

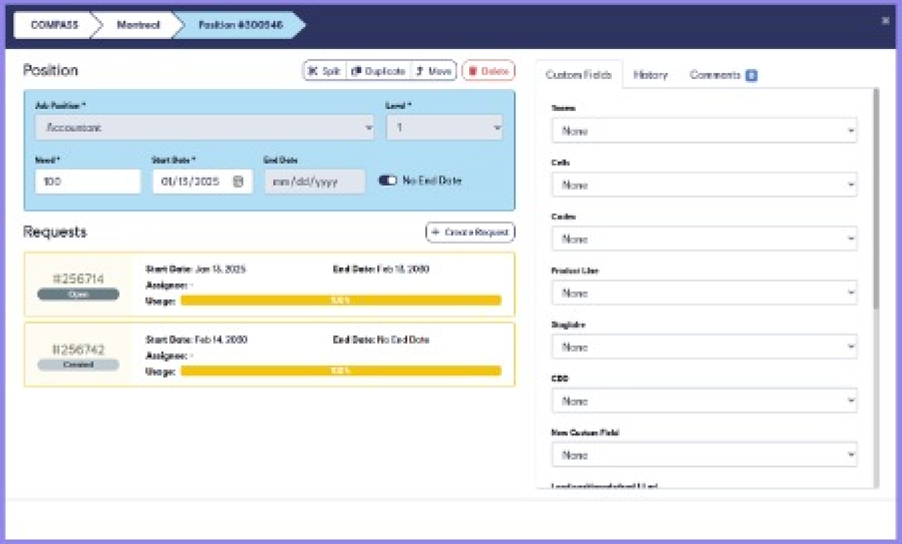
UX - EGG b/w components



UI - EGG components



Code - EGG components



This collaboration helped us define consistent component behaviors, simplify handoff, and keep both UX, UI and dev teams aligned.
Because of that shared foundation, developers were able to use the exact same components from our designs in production.

The Result

Faster implementation, fewer inconsistencies, and a tighter feedback loop between teams.
This was about building a product that could scale with confidence, using internal resources in smarter, more integrated ways.

Outcomes & Projected Impact

40% — **Estimated reduction in time-on-task** for core workflows by consolidating the navigation ribbon and standardizing modal layouts.

~60% — **Drop in date-syncing errors** achieved by splitting start/end date logic in the Advanced Date Editor.

35% — **Projected increase in global adoption** as usability improvements restored trust among previously skeptical studio leads.

4/5 — **Montreal Studio CSAT** (up from 3.5). Additionally, overall negative feedback dropped dramatically from **30%** in 2024 to just **10%** in 2025.

User Sentiment Shift

2024 Pre-Revamp Friction

"There is no common way to use it. The complexity for new users is high, and figuring out how to reallocate people is difficult."

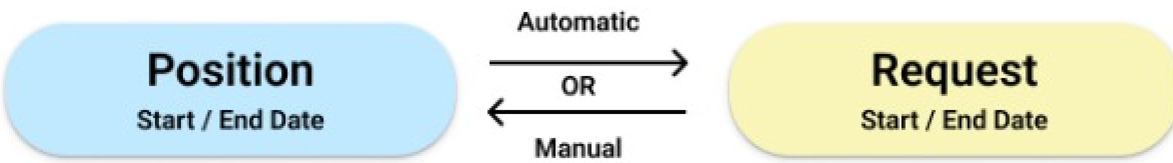
2025 Post-Revamp Adoption

"An essential tool for coordinating and monitoring staffing plans. We finally have consistency in data and a clean, logical visual UI/UX."

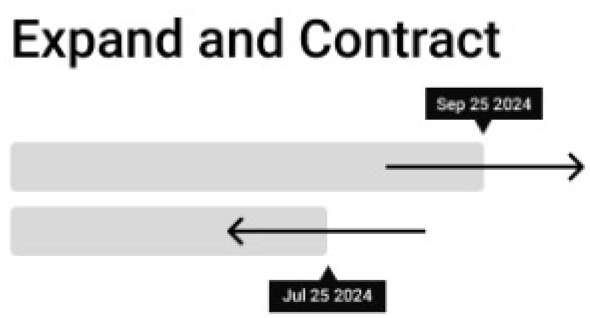
2025 Post-Revamp Feature Praise

"Being able to slide positions and requests directly in the timeline makes planning quite easy."

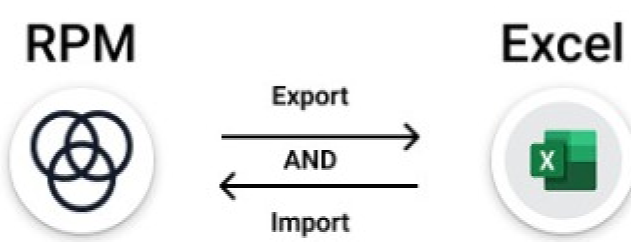
1



2



3



What Came Next

The end of this case study wasn't the end of RPM's evolution. Since completing the core redesigns, we've continued shipping high-impact updates that were made possible by the foundations we put in place.

1] Date Syncing Between Position and Request

Solved a long-standing pain point by aligning start and end date logic, reducing user error and eliminating sync-related confusion across modals.

2] Expand and Contract in the Gantt

Our most-requested feature—bringing speed and flexibility to setting start or end dates for positions and requests directly in the Gantt view.

3] Excel Import & Export

Designed for our Finance and Analysis users, this feature supports massive data changes with confidence.

Retrospective & Learnings

Validating through data

By securing buy-in to run ongoing Satisfaction Surveys, we moved away from reactive design. Tracking our progress allowed us to see mid-tenure user satisfaction (6m-3y) jump massively from a critical 2.6 up to 3.7, proving our foundational UX fixes actually solved the core frustration.

Understanding legacy systems

If I were to do this again, I would bring the back-end engineering team into the sketching phase much sooner. Understanding the deep database constraints around how "Requests" and "Positions" were inextricably linked would have accelerated my iteration process for the modal redesigns.

Growth as a systems thinker

This project required rigorous systems thinking. Rebuilding an enterprise tool used by 1000+ employees meant I had to understand the downstream impact of every single input. It taught me how to prioritize deep usability fixes that drive quantifiable business value, resulting in our flagship Montreal studio reaching a 4.0 satisfaction score.